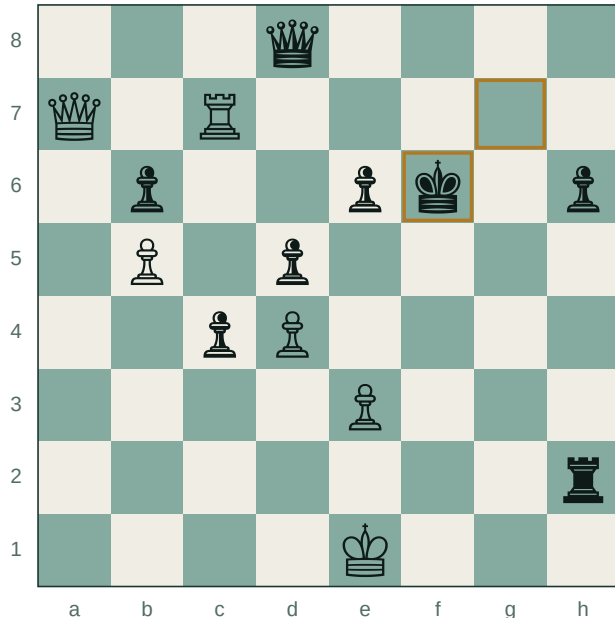


Clearance tactics: White, move 47

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 46...Kf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

47. Rf7+ Kg5 48. Rg7+ Kh4 49. Qf7 Qg5 50. Rxc5

47.Rf7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47...Kg5**.

48.Rg7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **48...Kh4**.

49.Qf7 The queen moves from a7 to f7. Recorded reply: **49...Qg5**.

50.Rxc5 The rook captures the queen on c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -2 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f6. Geometrically undefended: queen on d8 and rook on h2. Check for tactical protection.